

Word family: **build / builds / built / building / builder / rebuild / rebuildable**

Base word: build

Past tense: built

Past participle: built

Related forms: building, builder, rebuild

Useful expressions / extensions: build a house, build a bridge, build a team, build confidence, build a relationship, build up, build on, body build, build quality

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / related noun forms (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “These days, he is really into **building things**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **build** means:

> **to make or create something by putting parts or materials together**

Leo enjoys making things such as Lego structures, imaginary cities, rockets, and bridges.

繁體中文： **把不同部分、材料或零件組合起來，製作或建造成一個完整的東西**

中文翻譯：

> “He is really into building things.”

「他最近非常喜歡**建造 / 製作各種東西**。」

Here:

build things = 把不同部件組合起來，創造出完整的物件或結構

1. **build = construct something physical (建造) — 建造；興建；搭建**

This is the exact core sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He is really into **building things**.”

「他非常喜歡**建造 / 製作東西**。」

Practice 2

> “The children **built** a tower with blocks.”

「孩子們用積木**搭**了一座塔。」

Practice 3

> “They are **building** a new school.”

「他們正在**興建**一所新學校。」

build = 把材料、零件或部分組合起來，形成完整的物件或結構

2. **build** = make by assembling parts (組裝 / 製作) — 組裝；製作

This is especially relevant to Lego, models, machines, and DIY projects.

Practice 4

> “He **built** a model rocket.”

「他**製作**了一個火箭模型。」

Practice 5

> “She **built** the computer herself.”

「她自己**組裝**了那部電腦。」

build = 把各個零件或部分組合起來，製成一件完整物品

This overlaps with **construct**, but **build** is much more common in everyday English.

3. **build** a bridge/road/wall (大型結構) — 興建；建造

Practice 6

> “Workers are **building** a bridge across the river.”

「工人正在河上**興建**一座橋。」

Practice 7

> “They **built** a wall around the garden.”

「他們在花園四周**建了一道牆**。」

build = 建造較大型、固定或具結構性的實體設施

4. **build** = create something gradually (建立) — 建立 ; 逐步形成

A major abstract extension.

Practice 8

> “It takes time to **build** trust.”

「**建立信任**需要時間。」

Practice 9

> “They worked hard to **build** a strong relationship.”

「他們努力**建立穩固的關係**。」

build = 經過時間和努力，逐步建立某種抽象事物

Common objects:

- * trust
- * confidence
- * relationships
- * reputation
- * skills
- * habits
- * support

5. **build** a relationship (建立關係) — 建立 ; 培養關係

Practice 10

> “She quickly **built** a good relationship with the children.”

「她很快便和孩子們**建立了良好關係**。」

Practice 11

> “Regular communication helps **build relationships**.”

「定期溝通有助**建立關係**。」

****build a relationship = 經過互動、時間和努力逐漸建立人際連結****

6. ****build trust (建立信任) — 建立信任****

Practice 12

> “Honesty helps **build trust**.”

「誠實有助**建立信任**。」

Practice 13

> “It took years to **build** their trust.”

「花了多年才**建立起他們的信任**。」

****build trust = 經過行動和時間逐步令人產生信任****

7. ****build confidence (建立信心) — 增強 ; 建立自信****

Practice 14

> “Practice can **build confidence**.”

「練習可以**建立自信**。」

Practice 15

> “The teacher helped him **build his confidence**.”

「老師幫助他**建立信心**。」

****build confidence = 逐漸增加某人的自信和把握****

8. **build skills / knowledge** (培養能力 / 累積知識) — 培養；累積

Practice 16

> “Reading helps children **build vocabulary**.”

「閱讀有助孩子**累積詞彙量**。」

Practice 17

> “The course helps students **build practical skills**.”

「這個課程幫助學生**培養實用技能**。」

build skills/knowledge = 透過學習和練習逐漸增加能力或知識

9. **build a reputation** (建立聲譽) — 建立名聲 / 聲譽

Practice 18

> “The company has **built a strong reputation**.”

「公司已經**建立了良好聲譽**。」

Practice 19

> “She **built a reputation** for being reliable.”

「她逐漸**建立起可靠的名聲**。」

build a reputation = 經過一段時間，讓別人逐漸形成對某人 / 機構的固定評價

10. **build a business/company/organization** (建立事業 / 機構) — 創立；發展

Practice 20

> “He **built** the company from nothing.”

「他白手起家**建立了這間公司**。」

Practice 21

> “They spent years **building** the business.”

「他們花了多年**發展這盤生意**。」

build a business/organization = 創立並逐步發展一個機構、事業或系統

11. **build a team** (建立團隊) — 組建；培養團隊

Practice 22

> “The manager is trying to **build a strong team**.”

「經理正努力**建立一支強大的團隊**。」

Practice 23

> “It takes time to **build** an effective team.”

「**建立有效團隊**需要時間。」

build a team = 組成團隊並逐步培養成員之間的合作能力

12. **build a system/network/platform** (建立系統 / 網絡) — 建立；開發

Practice 24

> “Engineers **built** a new communication system.”

「工程師**建立了一套新的通訊系統**。」

Practice 25

> “The company is **building** an online platform.”

「公司正在**開發一個網上平台**。」

build = 設計、建立並逐步完成一個複雜系統或架構

This is especially common in technology.

13. **build software/app** (軟件) — 開發 ; 建立

Practice 26

> “The team **built** an app for students.”

「團隊為學生**開發**了一個應用程式。」

Practice 27

> “They are **building** new software.”

「他們正在**開發**新的軟件。」

build = 設計和建立軟件、程式或數碼產品

In computing, **build** can also have a more technical noun meaning, covered later.

14. **build** = increase gradually (逐漸增加) — 增強 ; 累積

A major intransitive/abstract branch.

Practice 28

> “Pressure began to **build**.”

「壓力開始**逐漸增加**。」

Practice 29

> “Excitement **built** as the event approached.”

「隨著活動臨近，興奮感**逐漸升高 / 累積**。」

build = 某種力量、感覺、壓力或程度逐漸增加

15. **tension / pressure / excitement builds** (逐漸累積) — 增加 ; 升高

Practice 30

> “Tension was **building** in the room.”

「房間裡的緊張氣氛正在**逐漸加劇**。」

Practice 31

> “Anticipation **built** throughout the week.”

「整個星期，期待感一直在**累積**。」

build = 情緒、壓力或氣氛逐步增強，而不是突然出現

16. **build up** = increase gradually (逐步累積) — 累積；逐漸增加

A very common phrasal extension.

Practice 32

> “Stress can **build up** over time.”

「壓力會隨時間**逐漸累積**。」

Practice 33

> “Dust had **built up** on the shelves.”

「架上已經**積**了很多灰塵。」

build up = 某物、某種程度或數量隨時間逐步增加 / 累積

17. **build up strength/confidence** (逐步增強) — 增強；培養

Practice 34

> “She is slowly **building up** her strength.”

「她正在慢慢**恢復 / 增強體力**。」

Practice 35

> “Small successes helped him **build up** confidence.”

「小小的成功幫助他逐漸**建立自信**。」

build up = 經過一段時間逐步增加某種能力、力量或程度

18. **build someone/something up** (提升形象 / 吹捧) — 捧高；大力宣傳

Another useful phrasal sense.

Practice 36

> “The media **built him up** as a future star.”

「媒體把他**大力吹捧成未來之星**。」

Practice 37

> “They **built up** the product before its launch.”

「產品推出前，他們對它進行了大量**宣傳造勢**。」

build someone/something up = 刻意提高別人對某人 / 某物的期待、形象或重要性

19. **build on** = develop from an existing foundation (以……為基礎發展) — 建基於；在……基礎上發展

A very important phrasal extension.

Practice 38

> “The new plan **builds on** earlier work.”

「新計劃**建基於**之前的工作。」

Practice 39

> “We should **build on** what we have learned.”

「我們應該**在已有的學習成果上繼續發展**。」

build on something = 以已有成果、想法或基礎作起點，進一步發展

20. **build into = incorporate/include as part of something (納入設計) — 加入 ; 內置**

Practice 40

> “Safety features are **built into** the system.”

「安全功能已經**內置於系統中**。」

Practice 41

> “Extra time was **built into** the schedule.”

「時間表中已經**預留了額外時間**。」

build something into X = 在設計或規劃時把某物納入其中，成為整體的一部分

21. **built-in = included as a permanent part (內置的) — 內置的 ; 固定設計在內的**

A major lexicalized adjective.

Practice 42

> “The laptop has a **built-in camera**.”

「這部手提電腦有**內置鏡頭**。」

Practice 43

> “The system includes **built-in protection**.”

「系統包含**內置保護功能**。」

built-in = 在設計 / 製造時已經包含在內，而不是後來另外加上的

22. **build = body shape / physique (體格) — 體型 ; 身材**

Now **build** functions as a noun.

Practice 44

> “He has a strong **build**.”

「他的**體格很強壯**。」

Practice 45

> “She is small in **build**.”

「她的**體型比較嬌小**。」

****build = 一個人的身體結構、體型和身材****

Common:

- * slight build
- * slim build
- * strong build
- * heavy build
- * athletic build

23. ****of medium/slight/heavy build (體型描述) — 中等 / 纖瘦 / 魁梧體型****

Practice 46

> “He is of medium **build**.”

「他屬於**中等體型**。」

Practice 47

> “The man was tall and of heavy **build**.”

「那個男人身材高大，而且**體格魁梧**。」

****of ... build = 用來描述一個人的身體結構和體型****

24. ****build = design/configuration of a product (版本 / 構造) — 構造；配置****

A useful technical/product sense.

Practice 48

> “The laptop has a solid **build**.”

「這部手提電腦的**機身結構很扎實**。」

Practice 49

> “The two models have different **builds**.”

「兩個型號的**構造 / 配置**不同。」

****build = 某個產品或物件的結構、配置或製造方式****

25. ****build quality (造工) — 製造質素 ; 造工****

Practice 50

> “The phone has excellent **build quality**.”

「這部手機的**造工非常好**。」

Practice 51

> “The cheaper model has weaker **build quality**.”

「較便宜的型號**造工較差**。」

****build quality = 產品在材料、組裝、結構和製造方面的整體質素****

26. ****build = software version generated from source code (軟件版本) — 編譯版本 ; 構建版本****

A genuine technical computing sense.

Practice 52

> “The latest **build** fixes several bugs.”

「最新的**軟件構建版本**修正了幾個程式錯誤。」

Practice 53

> “We tested a new **build** of the app.”

「我們測試了應用程式的一個新**構建版本**。」

****build** = 把程式碼編譯 / 組合後產生的特定軟件版本

This is common in software development.

27. ****build** — verb in computing = compile/create software (構建 / 編譯) — 建置 ; 編譯

Practice 54

> “The system automatically ****builds**** the application.”

「系統會自動**構建 / 編譯應用程式**。」

Practice 55

> “The code failed to ****build****.”

「程式碼**構建失敗 / 無法成功編譯**。」

****build** = 在軟件開發中把原始程式碼處理成可執行或可部署版本

28. ****builder** = person/company that builds (建築商 / 建造者) — 建築工人 ; 建築商 ; 建造者

Practice 56

> “The ****builder**** finished the house last month.”

「**建築商 / 建造者**上個月完成了房子。」

Practice 57

> “They hired a local ****builder****.”

「他們聘請了一位本地**建築承建商**。」

****builder** = 從事建造工作的人或公司

The exact Chinese depends on context.

29. ****builder = something that develops a quality (培養.....的東西) — 培養 / 增強工具****

A productive compound-like extension.

Practice 58

> “Team sports can be a great confidence ****builder****.”

「團隊運動可以非常有效地****建立自信****。」

Practice 59

> “The exercise is a good vocabulary ****builder****.”

「這項練習很適合****增加詞彙量****。」

****X-builder = 有助逐步增加、建立或培養某種能力 / 特質的事物****

30. ****building = structure/building (建築物) — 建築物 ; 大樓****

A lexicalized noun derived from the verb.

Practice 60

> “That ****building**** is over a hundred years old.”

「那棟****建築物****有超過一百年歷史。」

Practice 61

> “The office ****building**** has twenty floors.”

「那棟****辦公大樓****有二十層。」

****building = 由牆、屋頂等構成，供人居住、工作或進行活動的固定建築物****

This is more than simply “the act of building.”

31. ****building = process of creating/developing (建設 / 建立過程) — 建立 ; 建設****

Practice 62

> “Trust **building** takes time.”

「**建立信任**需要時間。」

Practice 63

> “Team **building** is important.”

「**團隊建設 / 建立團隊合作**很重要。」

building = 建造實體或逐步建立某種抽象事物的過程

32. **team-building** (團隊建設) — 團隊建立 ; 凝聚活動

Practice 64

> “The company organized a **team-building** activity.”

「公司舉辦了一項**團隊建立活動**。」

Practice 65

> “Good communication is important for **team-building**.”

「良好溝通對**團隊建設**很重要。」

team-building = 加強團隊合作、信任和關係的活動 / 過程

33. **rebuild** = build again (重建) — 重建 ; 重新建立

Practice 66

> “They **rebuilt** the bridge after the storm.”

「暴風雨後，他們**重建了那座橋**。」

Practice 67

> “It took years to **rebuild trust**.”

「花了多年才**重新建立信任**。」

****rebuild = 在某物被破壞、失去或削弱後再次建立****

Can be physical or abstract.

34. ****rebuild your life/confidence (重新建立) — 重整 ; 重建****

Practice 68

> “She slowly ****rebuilt her life****.”

「她慢慢****重整 / 重建自己的生活****。」

Practice 69

> “He needed time to ****rebuild his confidence****.”

「他需要時間****重新建立自信****。」

****rebuild = 在受挫、損失或破壞後逐步恢復原有結構、狀態或能力****

Important distinction: ****build vs make****

****make****

is extremely broad:

> create or produce almost anything.

****build****

usually emphasizes:

> assembling parts, creating structure, or developing something gradually.

Compare:

> “make a cake”



but normally not:

> “build a cake” ❌

Yet:

> “build a house”

is more natural than:

> “make a house.”

For Leo:

> **building things**

suggests construction and assembly.

Important distinction: **build vs construct**

build

ordinary and very broad.

construct

more formal/technical and often emphasizes deliberate assembly.

> build a house

> construct a bridge

Both are possible, but **build** is more natural in everyday speech.

Important distinction: **build vs create**

create

focuses on:

> bringing something new into existence.

build

focuses on:

> putting together parts or developing something gradually.

You can:

> create an idea

but you normally:

> build a relationship

because the relationship develops over time.

Important distinction: **build vs develop**

For abstract things they often overlap.

build

often emphasizes:

> gradual accumulation from a foundation.

develop

emphasizes:

> growth, improvement, or becoming more advanced.

> build confidence

> develop confidence

Both are possible, but **build** strongly suggests gradual strengthening.

Important distinction: **build vs establish**

establish

often means:

> formally create or firmly set up something.

build

focuses on:

> gradual development.

> establish a company

= 創立公司

> build a company

= 把公司逐步發展起來

Very useful difference.

Important distinction: **build a relationship vs start a relationship**

start

= relationship begins.

build

= relationship becomes stronger/deeper over time.

So:

> meeting someone starts a relationship

but:

> repeated interaction builds it.

Important distinction: **build trust vs earn trust**

build trust

= gradually develop mutual trust.

earn trust

= behave in ways that cause others to decide you deserve their trust.

They overlap, but **earn** emphasizes deserving it through actions.

Important distinction: build confidence vs gain confidence

build confidence

= gradually strengthen confidence, often through deliberate effort.

gain confidence

= become more confident.

Build emphasizes the process.

Important distinction: build = construct vs build = increase

Construct:

> “They built a house.”

= 建了一間屋。

Increase:

> “Pressure built.”

= 壓力逐漸增加。

The second no longer involves literal construction, but retains the metaphor of:

> layer upon layer accumulating.

Important distinction: build vs build up

build

can already mean gradual development:

> build confidence

build up

often emphasizes accumulation or gradual increase even more strongly:

> pressure built up

> dust built up

The phrasal form often implies something becoming progressively larger.

Important distinction: **build up vs build on**

build up

= increase/accumulate.

> build up strength

build on

= use something existing as a foundation for further development.

> build on previous research

Very different.

Important distinction: **build vs rebuild**

build

= create/develop.

rebuild

= create again after destruction, damage, loss, or decline.

> build trust

versus:

> rebuild trust after betrayal.

Important distinction: **build — verb vs build — physique**

Verb:

> “They built the bridge.”

= 他們建橋。

Noun:

> “He has a strong build.”

= 他體格強壯。

The noun sense is genuinely distinct and learner-relevant.

Important distinction: **build vs body shape**

build

focuses on overall body structure/frame.

shape

focuses more on visible outline/form.

> “He has a broad build.”

= 他體格寬厚。

> “The table has a round shape.”

= 桌子的形狀是圓的。

Important distinction: **build quality vs quality**

quality

is extremely broad.

****build quality****

specifically focuses on:

- * materials
- * assembly
- * structural solidity
- * manufacturing finish

A product can have:

> excellent software

but:

> poor build quality.

Important distinction: ****building vs build****

****building****

ordinary noun:

> physical structure.

****build****

technical/product noun:

> construction/configuration/version.

> “a tall building”

versus:

> “a solid build”

or:

> “the latest software build.”

Important distinction: **builder vs architect**

builder

physically carries out or manages construction.

architect

designs buildings and plans their structure.

The roles may work together but are not the same.

Family-extension note

Build is a strong polysemy and construction-rich word.

Its major semantic centres are:

- * **physical construction** → build a house
- * **assembly** → build a model/computer
- * **gradual abstract development** → build trust/confidence/reputation
- * **gradual increase** → pressure builds
- * **body structure** → strong build
- * **product structure** → build quality
- * **software version/process** → a new build / build the app

The useful family sweep adds:

- * **building**
- * **builder**
- * **rebuild**
- * **built-in**
- * **build up**
- * **build on**
- * **build into**

These should not all be treated as unrelated meanings. Many share the central conceptual image:

> **parts or layers gradually coming together to form something larger or stronger**

That matches the manual's principle of searching broadly while merging uses that retain one semantic core.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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build — physical construction	把材料或部件組合起來，形成完整的實體結構
build — assemble	把零件 / 部分組合起來製成完整物品
build — abstract development	經過時間和努力逐步建立某種抽象事物
build a relationship	經過互動和時間逐漸建立人際連結
build trust	逐步令人產生信任
build confidence	逐步增加自信和把握
build skills/knowledge	透過學習和練習逐漸增加能力或知識
build a reputation	經過時間逐漸形成固定聲譽
build a company/business	創立並逐步發展一個機構 / 事業
build a team	組建並逐步培養團隊合作
build a system/software	設計、建立或開發一個複雜系統 / 程式
build — increase	某種壓力、情緒或程度逐漸增加
build up — accumulate	某物或某種程度逐步累積
build up — strengthen	經過時間逐步增強某種能力、力量或程度
build someone/something up	提高其形象、重要性或別人的期待
build on	以已有成果 / 基礎作起點進一步發展
build into	在設計或規劃時把某物納入整體
built-in	在製造 / 設計時已永久包含在內的
build — physique	一個人的整體身體結構、體型和身材
build — product structure	產品的結構、配置或製造方式
build quality	產品在材料、組裝和結構方面的製造質素
build — software noun	由程式碼生成的某個特定軟件版本
build — computing verb	把程式碼處理成可執行 / 可部署版本
builder	從事建造工作的人 / 公司；亦可指能增強某種能力的事物
building — physical	供人居住、工作或進行活動的固定建築物
building — process	建造或逐步建立某種事物的過程
rebuild	在破壞、損失或削弱後再次建立 / 恢復

For your original sentence

> “These days, he is really into **building things**.”

The exact meaning is:

build = 把不同零件、材料或部分組合起來，創造出一個完整的物件或結構

Therefore:

> **building things**

= **「動手組裝、搭建和製作各種東西」**

In Leo's case, the following details clarify the meaning:

- > Lego
- > imaginary cities
- > paper rockets
- > cardboard bridges

So this is primarily the **physical construction / assembly sense**.

It is not:

- * **build trust** = 建立信任
- * **pressure builds** = 壓力累積
- * **strong build** = 強壯體格
- * **software build** = 軟件構建版本

The core image in your passage is very literal:

- > **parts → assembly → finished creation**.